

A general overview of the main journey of Freemasonry

Symbolic Masonry: Lodge of Free and Accepted Masons

The Symbolic Craft Lodge (Blue Lodge) is the first body of the American (York) Rite System

Candidates are:

- Initiated an Entered Apprentice (Entered Apprentice)
- Passed to the Degree of Fellow Craft (Fellow Craft)
- Raise to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason (Master Mason)

Members: Master Masons are styled "Brother"

-- York Rite or Ancient Craft Masonry --

Capitular Masonry: Chapter of Royal Arch Masons

The Capitular Masonry (Red Chapter) is the second body of the American (York) Rite System

Candidates are:

- Advanced to the Degree of Mark Master (Mark Master Mason)
- Inducted into the Oriental Chair (Past Master Virtual)
- Received and Acknowledged a Most Excellent Master (Most Excellent Master)
- Exalted to the Most Sublime Degree of Royal Arch (Royal Arch Mason)

Members: Royal Arch Masons are styled "Companion"

Cryptic Masonry: Council of Royal and Select Masters

The Cryptic Masonry (Purple Council) is the third body of the American (York) Rite System

Candidates are:

- Received a Royal Master (Royal Master)
- Greeted a Select Master (Select Master)

Honourary Degree(s)

Candidates are:

- Introduced into the mysteries of the Degree of Super Excellent Master (Super Excellent Master)

Members: Cryptic Masons are styled "Companion"

Chivalric Masonry: Commandery of Knights Templar

[This Body is both independent and yet a part of the York Rite. Members must be in good standing with Lodge, Chapter, and Council; or have just received the degrees of Chapter, and Council - in order to receive the Orders conferred by a Commandery. Additionally, this is one of the few instances where members make a declaration of faith. While a denomination is not requested to be named; all Sir Knights are members of one of the many Christian faiths or practices.]

The Chivalric Masonry (White Commandery) is the fourth body of the American (York) Rite System

Candidates are:

- Created and Constituted a Knight of the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross
- Admitted a Knight of the Order of St. Paul (or the Mediterranean Pass)
- Admitted a Knight of the Ancient Order of St. John of Jerusalem (or the Order of Malta)
- Created and Constituted Knight of the Order of the Temple [Knight Templar]

Members: Knight Templar are styled "Sir Knight"

-- Scottish Rite or Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry --

Lodge of Perfection (The Ineffable and Sublime Degrees)

[Note: the Scottish Rite has the Red Degrees 1° - 3°. As a matter of compromise, the Scottish Rite accepts the 3° Master Mason and proceeds through the rest of the Lodge of Perfection)

Candidates are:

Advanced to the Degree of Perfect Master (4° Perfect Master)

Received and Elected a Perfect Elu (14° Perfect Elu)

Chapter of Rose+Croix (The Historical and Religious Degrees)

Candidates are:

Received and Constituted a Knight of the Eagle and Pelican / Knight of Rose+Croix of the Order of Heredom (18° Knight Rose+Croix)

Council of Kadosh (The Philosophical And Chivalric Degrees)

Candidates are:

Created, Received and Constituted a Knight Kadosh of the White and Black Eagle and enrolled into the Order of Knights and Brethren of the Holy House of the Temple, poor Fellow-Soldiers of the Temple of Solomon [Templary- Knight Templar] - (30° Knight of Kadosh, or Knight of the White and Black Eagle)

Consistory of Masters of the Royal Secret (The Ceremonial and Official Degrees)

Candidates are:

Constituted a Disciple and Soldier of the Holy Doctrine, Anointed and Elevated a Master of the Royal Secret (32° Master of the Royal Secret)

Members: 32° Master of the Royal Secret are styled "Brother"

(The Invitational and Honourary Degrees)

The Court of Honour

Candidates are:

Invested with the Rank, Honour, and Decoration of Knight Commander of the Court of Honour (32° Knight Commander of the Court of Honour) [While not a Degree, the investiture is by Invitation, and is held at a public ceremony]

Members: 32° Knight Commander of the Court of Honour are styled "Honorable"

Coroneted an Inspector General of "The Supreme Council (Mother Council of the World) of the Inspectors General Knights Commander of the House of the Temple of Solomon of the Thirty-third Degree of the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry of the Southern Jurisdiction of the United States of America." (33° Inspector General Honourary)

Members: 33° Inspector General Honourary are styled "Illustrious"

Bestowed and Received a Knight of the Grand Cross of the Court of Honour 90r simply Grand Cross) of "The Supreme Council (Mother Council of the World) of the Inspectors General Knights Commander of the House of

the Temple of Solomon of the Thirty-third Degree of the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry of the Southern Jurisdiction of the United States of America." (33° Grand Cross of the Court of Honour)
Members: 33° Grand Cross of the Court of Honour are styled "Illustrious"